RENEWABLE AND NON-RENEWABLE RESOURCE DISCUSSION

Resources
Natural resources can be classified as either non-renewable or renewable.

Non-renewable resources cannot be replaced – once they are consumed they are gone for ever. Resources such as coal, iron, natural gas, uranium, and crude oil are all non-renewable. Some of these resources, such as coal and gas, can re-form. However, they take millions of years to do so, and as such cannot be renewed in a suitable timeframe to be considered renewable.

Renewable resources can be used, and within a few years or a few decades, they can be replaced. Resources such as trees, oxygen, and fresh water are renewable resources. Living things are often thought of as renewable resources because they reproduce. They will continually be replaced, as long as we don't over use them.

Energy
Natural resources are also used to provide energy.

Some non-renewable energy sources are called fossil fuels. Fossil fuels include coal, crude oil and natural gas.

Fossil fuels are made from the remains of plant matter that died millions of years ago. Swamps once covered large areas of the Earth and thick layers of dead plant material built up and were buried and compressed. These layers eventually turned into coal, crude oil or natural gas.

Renewable sources of energy, sometimes called alternative sources of energy, include solar, tidal power, wind power and geothermal power.

Instructions
1. Look at the 'discussion text' scaffold and identify the major parts of a discussion and the type of language features used in a discussion.
2. Form a small group.
3. Identify which of the following statements could be considered as arguments for and arguments against the statement **'Australia should stop using non-renewable resources'**.
4. Select the three most significant arguments for and the three most significant arguments against the statement.
5. Take notes into the 'arguments for' and 'arguments against' part of the scaffold. Add some elaboration sentences for each argument your have chosen.
6. Complete the scaffold by writing in dot points the Issue and Recommendation parts of the scaffold.
7. Write your final draft of the discussion in your book.

RENEWABLE AND NON-RENEWABLE RESOURCE DISCUSSION - continued

Once a non-renewable resourse is used it is gone for good.

Fossil fuels account for about 90% of the energy people use today.
How could we do without them?

The construction of dams may provide water to produce electric power, but it may also destroy scenic lands and wildlife habitats.

Unless people practice conservation, some shortages of resources may develop within the next 100 years.

Coal is plentiful and cheap. We have enough of it to supply our energy needs.

Solar cells do not work at night and the electricity they make needs to be stored in batteries. Most households cannot easily store this energy.

Fossil fuels produce lots of pollution such as carbon dioxide that is damaging our environment.

The electricity produced by alternitive sources is free but the solar cells, wind farms and tidal power plants are expensive and ugly.

Nuclear power is cheap and it does not produce any green house gases.

Tidal power, hydrothermal power and hydroelectricity provide regular, consistant power.

RENEWABLE AND NON-RENEWABLE DISCUSSION SCAFFOLD

TITLE: The use of renewable and non-renewable resources in Australia.

ISSUE – WHAT IS BEING DISCUSSED?	This section introduces the thing(s) being discussed.
ARGUMENT FOR – OUTLINE: ELABORATION:	Each paragraph addresses one argument – either for the issue or against it. Each paragraph outlines the argument and then elaborates upon that argument. An example is often included. Language features: Use modality words such as 'must', and 'should'. Use connecting words such as 'however', 'then', 'because', 'moreover' and 'therefore'. Use emotive words such as 'devastating', 'essential' and 'irreparable'. Use third person and present tense.
ARGUMENT FOR – OUTLINE: ELABORATION:	
ARGUMENT FOR – OUTLINE: ELABORATION:	
ARGUMENT AGAINST – OUTLINE: ELABORATION:	
ARGUMENT AGAINST – OUTLINE: ELABORATION:	
ARGUMENT AGAINST – OUTLINE: ELABORATION:	
CONCLUSION/RECOMMENDATION:	This section makes a recommendation based upon the arguments presented.